b.) All animals confiscated as a result of such violation shall be placed under the custody of the Office of the Provincial Veterinarian for care, rehabilitation, or humane disposition in accordance with national guidelines.

c.) When the offender is a juridical entity, the manager, proprietor, or responsible officer shall be held personally liable. All fines collected shall accrue to the Provincial Animal Welfare Fund, to be used exclusively for veterinary care, rescue, rehabilitation, and public education programs.

d.) Any person, natural, or juridical, found violating any provisions of this ordinance in lieu of prosecution may opt to pay of the administrative fines of Four Thousand Five Hundred Pesos (₱ 4,500.00) to the Provincial Treasurer's Office. Only those first offenders may avail the administrative fines provided this Ordinance.

ARTICLE V – IMPLEMENTING AGENCIES

Section 8. Implementing Partner Agencies. To ensure effective enforcement, the Provincial Government shall coordinate with:

a.) Department of Agriculture (DA) / Bureau of Animal Industry (BAI) – lead national agency for animal welfare compliance and rehabilitation;
b.) Philippine National Police (PNP) – to investigate, apprehend, and file cases against violators; and
c.) Accredited Animal Welfare Organizations (PAWS, etc.) – to assist in rescue, rehabilitation, and rehoming of confiscated horses; and
d.) Barangay Officials – to help report and prevent horse-fighting activities at the community level.

ARTICLE VI - IMPLEMENTATION

Section 9. **Implementation And Enforcement**

a.) The Office of the Provincial Veterinarian (OPV), in partnership with Municipal Agriculture Offices, shall serve as the lead implementing unit and conduct regular inspections;
b.) The PNP, Animal Welfare Enforcement Officers (AWEOs), and Barangay Officials shall actively monitor and investigate reports of illegal horse fighting;
c.) The Municipal LGUs shall enact supporting local ordinances and conduct information and education campaigns; and
d.) A Provincial Task Force Against Animal Cruelty shall be created to oversee implementation, enforcement, and case monitoring.

ARTICLE VII – CONFISCATION

Section 10. **Confiscation and Care of Animals.** Authorized enforcement officers may seize and impound animals involved in horse fights, provide emergency veterinary care, and place them under rehabilitation or adoption in accordance with law and subject to judicial order when required.

ARTICLE VIII – INFORMATION CAMPAIGN

Section 11. **Information and Advocacy.** The Provincial Government, through the OPV and in coordination with the DA–BAI Regulatory Division, shall conduct sustained information, education, and communication campaigns on animal welfare, emphasizing humane treatment, responsible ownership, and the legal consequences of cruelty.

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PROVINCE OF SIBUGAY AUTHENTICATED OSGTC Date 11-4-25